

DAK GURU



India's Smart Self-Preparation Portal for LDCE IP & PS Group 'B'

STUDY BOOKLET

Paper-II — Noting, Drafting & Major-Penalty Charge Sheet

LDCE for Inspector of Posts (LDCE IP)

Paper-II • 50 Marks Edition 2026 • September 2026

Disclaimer

These notes have been prepared by **Dak Guru** solely as a study aid for candidates preparing for the Limited Departmental Competitive Examination for Inspector of Posts (LDCE IP) and allied departmental examinations. They are an **independent, original work** intended to explain and summarise the subject in the compiler's own words.

Every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and to reflect the position in force as on the date of compilation, with reference to primary sources such as the **CSMOP, 2022**, the **CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965** and the **CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964**. However, rules, orders and instructions are amended from time to time. In case of any conflict, the **official Acts, Rules, Gazette notifications and Government orders in force shall prevail**.

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For LDCE IP & PS Group 'B' aspirants · September 2026



About these notes & how to use them

Paper-II of the LDCE IP tests three practical skills of office work — **Noting** (15 marks), **Drafting** (15 marks) and drafting a **Major-Penalty Charge Sheet** (20 marks). This booklet takes each in turn: it first explains the concept and the governing rules, then gives ready tables, do's-and-don'ts and, most importantly, **model answers** in the exact form the examiner expects.

How to use it:

- Read the concept boxes first, then study the **model note / drafts / charge sheet** until you can reproduce the *structure* from memory.
- Memorise the small tables — the parts of a note, the forms of communication, the four annexures of a charge sheet.
- Practise writing each answer to **~200 words** under time; then check it against the model.
- Watch the **Currency Alert** boxes — they flag the current position and common traps.



1

CHAPTER 1

Noting

Paper-II · Topic 1 · Noting in approx. 200 words on a given topic — 15 marks

A **note** is the writing on a file that carries a case forward towards a decision. In the exam you are given a **situation or a proposal** and asked to record a note, in about **200 words**, exactly as a dealing official would put it up for the orders of a superior. The examiner is testing three things at once — whether you can **grasp the point at issue**, whether you can **analyse it against the rules**, and whether you can **make a clear, defensible recommendation** in disciplined, official language. This chapter builds all three, strictly on the basis of the current *Central Secretariat Manual of Office Procedure (CSMOP)*, 2022 (16th edition, Department of Administrative Reforms & Public Grievances), whose **Chapter 7** deals with the guidelines on noting.

QUICK CONCEPT

What exactly is a "note"?

Under the CSMOP, a *note* is the remark recorded on a case to facilitate its disposal. It may contain a **précis (gist) of the previous papers**, a **statement of the point or points for decision**, an **analysis of the relevant facts, rules and precedents**, and finally a **suggested course of action**, on which the competent authority passes orders. In short: *facts* → *analysis* → *recommendation* → *orders*.

1.1 Where the note lives — the file and the Single File System

Every file has two portions — the **notes portion** (where officials and officers record their remarks, page-numbered on the left/green side) and the **correspondence portion** (the letters and papers received or issued, marked "/c"). Papers awaiting attention are the "**Papers Under Consideration**" or **PUC**. Under the **Single File System (SFS)**, the same file travels up and down the hierarchy carrying the noting, so your note must be **self-contained** and intelligible to every officer who reads it after you.

IN e-OFFICE / e-FILE

In e-Office / e-File

In the digital Secretariat, noting is done on the **"Notings" tab** of the e-File; the old green note-sheet is now a screen, and notes are authenticated by a **Digital Signature Certificate (DSC)** or e-Sign instead of ink. Movement of the file is captured automatically. The CSMOP, 2022 also renamed the functionaries — the old *Dealing Hand* is now the **Dealing Officer** (an Assistant Section Officer / Senior Secretariat Assistant), and the *Central Registry* is the **Central Registration Unit (CRU)**. The **principles of good noting are identical** on paper and on screen.

1.2 Types of notes

Not every note is a full essay. Recognising the **kind of note** the situation calls for is half the battle:

1. **Routine / running note** — a short remark that keeps a case moving, e.g. "*PUC may be seen*", "*May be filed*", "*Ack. issued*". A single line, signed and dated.
2. **Note recording a decision or order** — where an officer records the orders passed, e.g. sanction accorded, leave granted, proposal approved.
3. **Full-scale / analytical note** — the substantial note that sets out the case, analyses it against the rules and precedents, and makes a recommendation. **This is the type tested in the exam.**
4. **Note on a running summary of facts** — in a long-drawn case, a *Running Summary of Facts* is maintained separately; an officer noting on such a file need not repeat the facts but only record his view on the point at issue.

1.3 Anatomy of a good analytical note

A well-built note moves in a fixed sequence. Train your hand to follow it every single time:

Part	What it does	Typical opening
Subject	Names the issue in one line so any reader knows the case at a glance.	"Subject: Proposal for ..."
Reference to PUC	Points to the paper that triggered the case, by page number.	"The proposal at pp. 3–5/c ..."
Statement of facts	Gives only the facts needed for the decision — briefly, in your own words.	"Briefly, the facts are ..."

Analysis	Tests the facts against the relevant rule / order / precedent, cited by number.	"Under Rule ... / As per the order dated ..."
Point for decision	States precisely what has to be decided.	"The point for decision is whether ..."
Recommendation	Gives a clear, reasoned suggestion.	"It is recommended that ..."
Submission	Puts the file up to the deciding authority.	"Submitted for orders / approval."

1.4 Guidelines for noting (CSMOP, 2022, Chapter 7)

The Manual lays down clear rules of the craft. The most important, in exam-ready form:

- All notes must be **concise and to the point**; lengthy notes are to be avoided. Shift bulky material to a statement or appendix placed below.
- Do **not** reproduce or paraphrase the paper under consideration; the PUC is already on the file — just refer to it by page number.
- Every note should be **self-contained** and lead logically to the point for decision.
- Cite the **rule, order or precedent** relied upon **by its number and date**; do not rely on vague memory.
- **Never erase or overwrite** an earlier note. A mistake or change of view is recorded through a **fresh note**, not by altering what is already signed.
- Number the paragraphs; use **black or blue ink** in manual noting (or e-noting in e-Office).
- Be **courteous and impersonal**; avoid intemperate or accusatory language even when disagreeing.
- **Sign** with full signature, **name, designation and date**. An unsigned, undated note has no value.

CURRENCY ALERT

Currency alert

These guidelines are drawn from the **CSMOP, 2022 (16th edition)** — the edition in force as verified on the DARPG website. Booklets still built on the 15th edition (2019) or earlier carry the older terminology (*Dealing Hand, Central Registry*). Use the **2022 vocabulary** in your answer where the terminology matters.

1.5 Aids to processing

The Manual provides tools that make noting faster and more consistent. Knowing them earns easy marks in theory questions and improves your practical answer:

- **Running Summary of Facts** — a continuously updated gist of a long case, so senior officers need not wade through the whole file.
- **Standard Process Sheet** — a pre-printed sequence of check-points for a recurring, repetitive type of case.
- **Check-list / points of reference** — ready reminders of the rules and stages to be verified.
- **Standard forms and precedent folders** — model drafts and past decisions kept ready for reuse.

1.6 Do's and Don'ts of noting

DO	DON'T
• Read the topic twice and fix the exact point for decision before writing. • Keep to about 200 words; be crisp. • Number your paragraphs. • Quote the rule / order by number and date. • End with a clear recommendation and "Submitted for orders". • Sign with designation and date.	• Don't reproduce the whole PUC or copy the question back. • Don't record personal opinions unsupported by any rule. • Don't pre-judge or use discourteous language. • Don't leave the note hanging without a recommendation. • Don't overwrite or erase — add a fresh note instead. • Don't forget the subject line.

1.7 Model note (≈ 200 words)

Given topic: "Record a note on the proposal for shifting a Branch Post Office to a new rented building." A model answer in the correct form:

MODEL NOTE

Subject: Proposal for shifting Wadgaon Branch Office to a new rented building.

1. The Sub-Divisional Inspector, in his report at pp. 3–5/c, has proposed shifting of Wadgaon B.O. from its present premises to a new building offered by the owner at a monthly rent of Rs. 2,500/-.
2. The present building (rent Rs. 1,800/- p.m.) is reported to be dilapidated and situated at one corner of the village, causing inconvenience to the public. The proposed building is on the main road, has adequate space and security, and lies closer to the centre of the delivery area.
3. The Assistant Engineer (Civil) has certified the proposed premises as structurally sound (p. 7/c). The rent is within the fair rent assessed, and the additional expenditure of Rs. 700/- p.m. is within the financial powers of the Divisional Head.
4. The proposal is thus justified on grounds of public convenience and the safety of postal cash and articles. There is no objection on record.
5. It is **recommended** that the shifting of Wadgaon B.O. to the new premises on a monthly rent of Rs. 2,500/-, with effect from a date to be fixed, may kindly be **approved**.

Submitted for orders, please.

Sd/- (Name)

Postal Assistant / Head Clerk

Date: __.__.2026

EXAM FOCUS

Exam focus — scoring the 15 marks

- Open with the **subject**; close with a **recommendation** and **submission**. These two anchors alone signal a trained hand.

- Show **one rule citation** at least — it proves you can tie facts to authority.
- Stay near **200 words**; padding loses more than it gains.
- Sign off with a **designation and date** — markers look for it.

1.8 Phrase bank — standard expressions for notes

Official noting has a settled vocabulary. Using it signals a trained hand and saves words. The expressions below are the departmental stock-in-trade at each stage of a note:

Stage of the note	Standard expressions
Opening	"This is regarding ..."; "The PUC at pp. __/c is a proposal for ..."; "Reference note at p. __/N."
Stating facts	"It is observed that ..."; "As per records, ..."; "The facts of the case, briefly, are ..."
Citing authority	"Under Rule __ of ..."; "As per the orders contained in letter No. __ dated __ ..."; "The competent authority in this behalf is ..."
Analysis	"The case may be examined as under:"; "In view of the above, ..."; "Prima facie, ..."
Proposal	"It is proposed that ..."; "The following course of action is suggested:"; "Necessary action may be taken."
Submission	"Submitted for orders, please."; "Submitted for kind perusal and approval."; "DA may kindly approve."

MEMORY TRICK

Memory trick — F-R-A-P-S

A complete note walks through **Facts** → **Rule** → **Analysis** → **Proposal** → **Submission**. If your answer touches all five, the framework marks are yours.

1.9 Model note 2 — recovery of a loss caused by negligence

Given topic: "An inspection has revealed an excess payment at a Sub Office. Record a note proposing action against the officials responsible." A model answer:

MODEL NOTE — RECOVERY OF LOSS

Subject: Excess payment of Rs. 60,000/- on closure of an RD account at Khaparkheda S.O.
— action against officials responsible.

1. The inspection report of Khaparkheda S.O. at pp. 4–9/c discloses that, on closure of RD Account No. ____ on __.__.2026, Rs. 2,10,000/- was paid to the depositor against the closure value of Rs. 1,50,000/-, an **excess payment of Rs. 60,000/-**.
2. Verification shows that Shri A ____, PA, computed the closure value wrongly, and Shri B ____, SPM, passed the voucher without the prescribed check. The loss is attributable to the **negligence of both officials**; there is no indication of fraud.
3. Under **Rule 11(iii) of the CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965**, recovery from pay of the whole or part of a pecuniary loss caused to Government by negligence is a **minor penalty**, imposable after following the procedure in **Rule 16**.
4. It is therefore proposed that (i) minor-penalty proceedings under Rule 16 be initiated against both officials, proposing recovery of Rs. 30,000/- each; (ii) steps be taken in parallel to recover the excess amount from the payee; and (iii) the case be watched as a special item till the loss is made good.
5. Draft memoranda under Rule 16 are placed for approval at __/c.

Submitted for orders, please.

Sd/- (Name)

Office Supervisor

Date: __.__.2026

1.10 Model note 3 — write-off of an irrecoverable loss

Given topic: "Record a note seeking sanction for write-off of the value of damaged articles of stock." A short-form model:

MODEL NOTE — WRITE-OFF PROPOSAL

Subject: Write-off of Rs. 4,800/-, being the value of stock articles damaged in the flooding of ____ S.O.

1. The Sub-Divisional Head has reported (pp. 2–3/c) that rain-water entered ____ S.O. on the night of __.__.2026 and damaged one office chair, one storage rack and assorted stationery, together valued at **Rs. 4,800/-** as per the inventory at p. 4/c.
2. The damage arose from a natural cause; the report finds **no negligence** on the part of any official, and no recovery from any source is possible. The loss is therefore **irrecoverable**.
3. The amount falls **within the financial powers delegated to the Divisional Head** for write-off of irrecoverable losses under the Schedule of Financial Powers.
4. It is proposed that sanction be accorded for **write-off of Rs. 4,800/-** and that a formal **Order** conveying the sanction be issued; the stock registers will be corrected accordingly. A draft Order is placed at 5/c.

Submitted for sanction, please.

Sd/- (Name)

Office Supervisor

Date: __.__.2026

2

CHAPTER 2

Drafting

Paper-II · Topic 2 · Drafting in approx. 200 words on a given topic — 15 marks

Where a *note* records the thinking inside the office, a **draft** is the communication that goes **out** of the office once a decision is taken. **Drafting** is the art of turning an approved decision into a clear, correctly-formatted communication. In the exam you are given a topic — “*draft a letter calling for a report*”, “*draft an office order transferring an official*” — and asked to produce the communication in about **200 words**, in the **right form**, with the **right salutation and subscription**. This chapter is based on the CSMOP, 2022, whose **Chapter 8** prescribes the *forms of communication* and **Chapter 9** the *guidelines on drafting*.

2.1 Forms of written communication

The first decision in any drafting question is **which form** to use — each form has its own occasion, person (first or third), salutation and subscription. Learn this table cold; picking the wrong form loses marks even if the language is good.

Form	When it is used	Person / Salutation / Subscription
Letter	Correspondence with State & foreign Governments, the UPSC and other constitutional/statutory bodies, heads of attached & subordinate offices, public bodies and members of the public.	First person (“I am directed to...”). Salutation Sir / Madam ; subscription Yours faithfully .
Demi-Official (D.O.) letter	Officer-to-officer, to invite personal attention or exchange views informally; addressee usually not more than one–two levels apart.	First person, personal tone. Dear Shri ... / My dear ...; Yours sincerely .
Office Memorandum (O.M.)	Correspondence between departments , or calling for /	Third person; no salutation or subscription — only

	conveying information to employees.	name & designation of the signatory.
Inter-Departmental / U.O. Note	To obtain the advice, views or concurrence of another department on a file referred to it.	Third person; recorded on the file or on a note-sheet.
Office Order	Internal, day-to-day administration — transfers, distribution of work, leave, local arrangements.	Impersonal; issued in the name of the head of office.
Order	To convey a Government sanction or decision — financial sanctions, disciplinary orders, etc.	Impersonal; signed by the competent authority.
Notification	Matters required to be published in the Gazette of India — statutory rules, appointments, delegations of power.	Impersonal, formal; published in the Gazette.
Resolution	To announce Government policy decisions , constitution of committees, or the results of important reviews.	Impersonal; usually published in the Gazette.
Press Communiqué / Note	For release to the press — a <i>communiqué</i> is formal and reproduced verbatim; a <i>note</i> is for background/informal use.	Impersonal.
Endorsement	To forward a copy of a communication to others for information or action.	"Copy forwarded to..." below the main communication.

CURRENCY ALERT**Currency alert**

The CSMOP, 2022 gives specimen formats of the **Letter, D.O. letter, O.M., Office Order, Order, Inter-Departmental Note, Notification, Resolution and Press Communiqué/Note** in the appendix to Chapter 8. Older editions also listed the **telegram / savingram**; these have effectively been **replaced by e-mail and fax** in the digital Secretariat. Answer with the current-relevant set above.

2.2 General principles of drafting (CSMOP, 2022, Chapter 9)

- Carry the message **clearly, precisely and courteously** — a draft is read by an outsider, so leave no room for doubt.
- Use **simple, direct language**; avoid officialese, verbosity and pompous phrases.
- Deal with **one point per paragraph**, and **number** the paragraphs.
- Give a **subject heading**, and quote the **reference** (the letter number and date being replied to).
- **Check every fact and figure** against the file before signing.
- Indicate clearly the **action required** and, where relevant, a **time-limit**.
- Mark **enclosures** and list the addressees of any **copies**.
- Choose the correct **form, salutation and subscription** for the occasion.

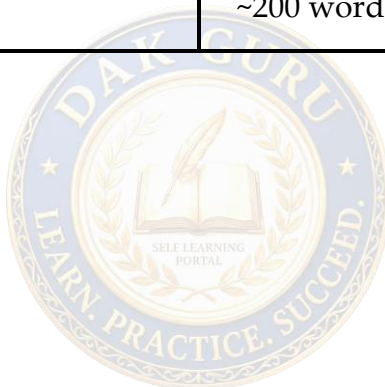
2.3 Structure of a draft

A complete draft carries these elements in order — omit none in your answer:

1. Name of the **office / letterhead**.
2. **File / letter number** and **date** (place and date).
3. **"To"** — the addressee, with designation and address.
4. **Subject** line.
5. **Reference** (if replying to an earlier communication).
6. **Salutation** — only where the form requires it (Letter / D.O.).
7. **Body** — numbered paragraphs.
8. **Subscription** — where the form requires it.
9. **Signature block** — signature, name, designation, telephone / e-mail.
10. **Enclosures** and **"Copy to"** (endorsement).

2.4 Do's and Don'ts of drafting

DO	DON'T
• Fix the form first (Letter? O.M.? Office Order?). • Match salutation and subscription to the form. • Give a subject and a reference. • Write short, numbered paragraphs. • State the action and any time-limit. • Close with the signature block.	• Don't mix forms — no “Sir” in an O.M. • Don't use flowery or ambiguous language. • Don't cram several points into one paragraph. • Don't forget the subject or the reference. • Don't leave out enclosures / copies. • Don't exceed the length badly — aim ~200 words.



2.5 Model drafts

Given topic (a): "Draft an Office Order transferring Postal Assistants within a Division."

MODEL – OFFICE ORDER

Department of Posts, India
OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDENT OF POST OFFICES,
NAGPUR CITY DIVISION, NAGPUR – 440 001

No. B1/Estt/Transfers/2026

Dated at Nagpur the __.__.2026

OFFICE ORDER

Consequent on administrative requirements, the following transfers and postings of Postal Assistants are ordered with immediate effect, in the interest of service:

Name / Desig.	From	To
Shri A ____, PA	Nagpur City H.O.	Sitabuldi S.O.
Shri B ____, PA	Sitabuldi S.O.	Nagpur City H.O.

2. The officials relieved will hand over and take over charge and join their new offices within the joining time admissible under the Rules. Travelling allowance, if admissible, will be regulated as per the rules in force.

Sd/- (Name)
Superintendent of Post Offices,
Nagpur City Division

Copy to:

- (i) The officials concerned through their Postmasters / Sub-Postmasters;
- (ii) The Postmaster, Nagpur City H.O. / The Sub-Postmaster, Sitabuldi S.O.; (iii) Establishment file.

Given topic (b): "Draft a letter calling for a delayed report from a Sub-Office."

MODEL — LETTER

Department of Posts, India

Office of the Supdt. of Post Offices, Nagpur City Dn., Nagpur – 440 001

No. C2/Statistics/2026

Dated at Nagpur the __.__.2026

To

The Sub-Postmaster,
Hingna S.O. – 441 110.

Subject: Submission of the monthly statistical return for August 2026 — reg.

Sir,

I am directed to state that the monthly statistical return of your office for August 2026, due on the 3rd instant, has not been received in this office so far.

2. The delay has held up the consolidation of the Divisional return. You are requested to submit the return **immediately, and in any case not later than __.__.2026**, and to ensure that returns are submitted by the due date in future.
3. The receipt of this letter may be acknowledged.

Yours faithfully,

Sd/- (Name)

Superintendent of Post Offices,
Nagpur City Division

EXAM FOCUS

Exam focus — scoring the 15 marks

- Marks are lost most often for the **wrong form** or a **mismatched salutation/subscription** — get these right first.
- Always show the **subject** and, in a reply, the **reference**.
- Keep the body to **two or three numbered paragraphs**; end with the **signature block**.
- For an O.M., write in the **third person with no "Sir" and no "Yours faithfully"** — a classic trap.

2.6 Model – Demi-Official (D.O.) letter

Given topic: "Write a D.O. letter to a fellow Divisional Head requesting early completion of a pending verification." The D.O. is written in the **first person**, in a personal and friendly tone, with the writer's name and designation at the top:

MODEL – DEMI-OFFICIAL (D.O.) LETTER

A ____ (Name)

Superintendent of Post Offices

Nagpur City Division, Nagpur – 440 001

Tel.: ____

D.O. No. A1/Verification/2026

Dated at Nagpur the __.__.2026

Dear ____,

Kindly refer to my office letter No. ____ dated __.__.2026 regarding verification of the service particulars of Shri R ____, PA, transferred to my Division from yours.

2. The official's pay fixation and leave account are held up for want of the verified statement, and he has been representing about the hardship. I shall be grateful if you could kindly have the verification completed and the statement sent to us **by** __.__.2026.

3. I am sorry to trouble you personally in the matter, but the case is now quite old.

With regards,

Yours sincerely,

Sd/- (A ____)

Shri B ____,

Superintendent of Post Offices,

____ Division, ____ – ____.

2.7 Model – Office Memorandum (O.M.)

Given topic: "Draft an Office Memorandum to another Department calling for / furnishing information." The O.M. is written in the **third person**, carries **no salutation and no subscription**, and is used between Departments and with attached or subordinate offices:

MODEL – OFFICE MEMORANDUM

No. C3/Coord/2026

Government of India

Ministry of Communications · Department of Posts

(O/o the Superintendent of Post Offices, Nagpur City Division)

Nagpur – 440 001

Dated the __.__.2026

OFFICE MEMORANDUM

Subject: Furnishing of particulars required for ____ – regarding.

The undersigned is directed to refer to the Department of ____'s O.M. No. ____ dated __.__.2026 on the subject cited above, and to say that the information called for is being collected from the field units.

2. The consolidated particulars in the prescribed proforma will be furnished by __.__.2026. Information in respect of ____ is, however, enclosed herewith.

3. The receipt of this O.M. may kindly be acknowledged.

Sd/- (Name)

Assistant Superintendent (HQ)

Tel.: ____

To

The Department of ____

(____ Section), New Delhi.

2.8 Model — memo calling for an explanation

Given topic: "An official has remained absent without sanctioned leave. Draft the communication calling for his explanation." Keep the tone firm but impersonal, state the lapse with dates, and give a clear time-limit:

MODEL — EXPLANATION-CALL MEMO

Department of Posts, India
Office of the Superintendent of Post Offices,
Nagpur City Division, Nagpur – 440 001

No. B2/Discipline/2026

Dated at Nagpur the __.__.2026

MEMO

Subject: Unauthorised absence from duty — explanation called for.

Shri R ____, Postal Assistant, ____ S.O., absented himself from duty from __.__.2026 to __.__.2026 without applying for leave and without intimation to the office, as reported by the Sub-Postmaster in his letter No. ____ dated __.__.2026.

2. Absence without authorisation disrupts public service and constitutes failure to maintain the **devotion to duty** expected of a Government servant under **Rule 3(1)(ii) of the CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964**.

3. Shri R ____ is directed to submit his **written explanation within seven days** of receipt of this Memo, stating the reasons for the absence together with supporting documents, if any, failing which it will be presumed that he has no explanation to offer and further action will be taken under the relevant rules on the material available.

Sd/- (Name)
Superintendent of Post Offices,
Nagpur City Division

To

Shri R ____, Postal Assistant, ____ S.O. (through the Sub-Postmaster).

2.9 Model — inspection report of an Inspector of Posts (fraud case)

Given topic: "During your inspection you detect that deposits collected at a single-handed office were not brought to account. Report to the Divisional Head." A report is a **letter-form** communication built on clear sub-headings; each head answers one question the superior will ask:

MODEL — INSPECTION REPORT (FRAUD DETECTED)

Department of Posts, India

O/o the Inspector of Posts, ____ Sub-Division, Nagpur – 440 ____

No. INSP/____/2026 (Confidential)

Dated the __.__.2026

To

The Superintendent of Post Offices, Nagpur City Division, Nagpur – 440 001.

Subject: Non-credit of RD deposits detected during inspection of ____ S.O. (single-handed) — report — reg.

- 1. How detected.** During the annual inspection on __.__.2026, pass-books obtained from depositors were compared with office records; balances in __ **RD accounts** did not tally.
- 2. Modus operandi.** The SPM, Shri R ____, received RD deposits in cash and made pass-book entries under his initials and date-stamp, but **did not bring the amounts to account**, retaining the cash. Discrepant vouchers were traced for __.__.2026 to __.__.2026.
- 3. Extent.** Non-credits established so far total **Rs. ____/-** across __ accounts (statement enclosed). Statements of the depositors and of the SPM, who has **admitted receipt**, are enclosed.
- 4. Action taken.** The relevant records have been seized and listed; the cash balance was verified; the remaining accounts tallied.
- 5. Recommendations.** (i) Consideration of **suspension** of the official and entrustment of the office to another official; (ii) **100% past-work verification** of the office; (iii) recovery and restoration of the credits to the depositors; (iv) initiation of **major-penalty proceedings under Rule 14**, and reporting to police if warranted by the monetary limits in force; (v) change of the office date-stamp.

Submitted for information and further orders, please.

Sd/- (Name)

Inspector of Posts, ____ Sub-Division

3

CHAPTER 3

Major-Penalty Charge Sheet

Paper-II · Topic 3 · Draft a Major-Penalty Charge Sheet
— 20 marks

This is the highest-weighted item in Paper-II. You are asked to **draft the charge sheet** (charge memorandum) that begins a **major-penalty disciplinary proceeding** against a Government servant. To do it well you must know two sets of rules together — the **CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964**, which define what counts as **misconduct**, and the **CCS (Classification, Control and Appeal) Rules, 1965 (CCS (CCA) Rules)**, which prescribe the **procedure**. The charge sheet itself is issued under **Rule 14** of the CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965.

3.1 The disciplinary framework

Instrument	Role
CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964 — Rule 3	Defines the standard of conduct. Every Government servant shall at all times (i) maintain absolute integrity ; (ii) maintain devotion to duty ; (iii) do nothing unbecoming of a Government servant. A breach of Rule 3 is the usual foundation of a charge.
CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965 — Rule 11	Lists the penalties — minor and major.
Rule 12 / Rule 13	Identify the Disciplinary Authority and the authority competent to institute proceedings.
Rule 14	Prescribes the procedure for imposing major penalties — the charge sheet, the inquiry, and the report. <i>This is the rule under which the charge sheet is drafted.</i>
Rule 15 / Rule 16	Rule 15 — action on the inquiry report (major penalty); Rule 16 — the simpler procedure for minor penalties.

3.2 Penalties under Rule 11 — minor vs. major

Whether you draft a **charge sheet under Rule 14** or a **memorandum under Rule 16** depends entirely on the penalty in contemplation. Rule 14 applies **only** where a **major penalty** — clauses (v) to (ix) — is proposed.

Minor penalties — Rule 11 (i)–(iv), (iiia)	Major penalties — Rule 11 (v)–(ix)
(i) Censure	(v) Reduction to a lower stage in the time-scale of pay for a specified period (save as in (iiia))
(ii) Withholding of promotion	(vi) Reduction to a lower time-scale of pay, grade, post or Service
(iii) Recovery from pay of pecuniary loss caused to Government	(vii) Compulsory retirement
(iiia) Reduction to a lower stage in the pay by one stage for up to 3 years, without cumulative effect and not affecting pension	(viii) Removal from service (not a disqualification for future Government employment)
(iv) Withholding of increments of pay	(ix) Dismissal from service (ordinarily a disqualification for future Government employment)

QUICK CONCEPT

The golden test

Major penalty (v)–(ix) → Rule 14 → full charge sheet + inquiry. Minor penalty (i)–(iv)/(iiia) → Rule 16 → a memorandum with a statement of imputations, no formal inquiry unless the official asks or the authority orders one. Read the exam scenario for the *penalty in view*; if it points to reduction in rank, compulsory retirement, removal or dismissal, you are in **Rule 14** territory.

3.3 Rule 14 procedure at a glance

1. The **Disciplinary Authority (DA)** forms the opinion that there are grounds to inquire into an imputation of misconduct.
2. The DA **draws up (i) the Articles of Charge** and **(ii) the Statement of Imputations**, together with a **list of documents and witnesses**.

3. The DA **delivers the charge memorandum** to the Government servant and requires a **written statement of defence** within a specified time, and asks whether he wishes to be heard in person.
4. On the defence, if the charges are **denied**, the DA holds the inquiry itself or appoints an **Inquiring Authority (IO)** and a **Presenting Officer (PO)**.
5. **Inquiry:** inspection of listed documents; examination, cross-examination and re-examination of witnesses; defence evidence; questioning of the Government servant; and written briefs.
6. The IO submits an **inquiry report** with reasoned **findings on each Article of Charge**.
7. Under **Rule 15**, the DA considers the report, gives the Government servant a copy for representation, consults the **UPSC / CVC** where required, and passes the **final order**.

CURRENCY ALERT

Currency alert

The Rule 14 procedure summarised above reflects the current text of the CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965 as available on the DoPT website — including the amendment that fixed the appearance of the Government servant at **within ten working days**, introduced the **Presenting Officer**, and allowed assistance by a **retired Government servant**. The most recent amendment to the CCS (CCA) Rules — **DoPT Notification dated 12.01.2026** — amended **Rule 10(1) (suspension)** and **Rule 12(4) (disciplinary authority)**, and **does not alter** the charge-sheet mechanism of Rule 14.

3.4 The charge memorandum and its four annexures

A major-penalty charge sheet is not a single sheet but a **memorandum with four annexures**. Reproducing this structure correctly is the backbone of the 20-mark answer:

Component	What it contains
Memorandum	The covering charge sheet under Rule 14 — states that an inquiry is proposed, refers to the four annexures, and directs the official to submit a written statement of defence.
Annexure-I — Statement of Articles of Charge	The charges themselves, framed as definite and distinct Articles (Article-I, Article-II ...).

Annexure-II — Statement of Imputations	The facts and evidence supporting each Article — dates, places, amounts, acts and omissions, and any admission/confession.
Annexure-III — List of Documents	The documents by which the Articles of Charge are proposed to be sustained .
Annexure-IV — List of Witnesses	The witnesses by whom the Articles of Charge are proposed to be sustained .

3.5 How to frame the Articles of Charge (Annexure-I)

- Frame each charge as a **definite and distinct Article** — one act of misconduct per Article.
- Be **specific and precise**: state *who, what, when, where*. Avoid vague, general accusations.
- Tie every Article to the **rule violated** — normally **Rule 3(1)(i), (ii) and/or (iii) of the CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964** (integrity / devotion to duty / conduct unbecoming).
- Ensure the Articles and the Imputations **match** — every serious irregularity narrated in Annexure-II must be reflected in an Article in Annexure-I.
- Do **not** pre-judge guilt; the Article states the *charge*, not a finding.

GOLDEN RULE

Common defects that get charge sheets quashed

- Charges framed too **generally** ("acted in an unbecoming manner") without stating the concrete act.
- **Mismatch** — grave irregularities appear in the imputations but not in the articles of charge.
- The **wrong / incompetent authority** signs the memorandum (the DA competent for the *major* penalty must sign).
- **Illegible or incomplete** copies of documents supplied to the charged official.
- The misconduct is **not tied** to any specific Conduct Rule.

3.6 How to draft the Statement of Imputations (Annexure-II)

The imputations are the **narrative and evidence** behind the charges. For each Article, set out the relevant facts — the dates and place, the specific acts or omissions, the amounts involved, how the misconduct was detected, and the documents and witnesses relied upon. Include any admission or confession made by the Government servant. The imputations must **substantiate every Article** and must not travel beyond them.

3.7 Complete specimen charge sheet (Memorandum + Annexures I–IV)

Given topic: "Draft a major-penalty charge sheet against a Postal Assistant who misappropriated Savings Bank money and falsified records." A model in the correct form (names, amounts and dates are illustrative):

See Next Page...



MEMORANDUM

Department of Posts, India
Office of the Superintendent of Post Offices,
Nagpur City Division, Nagpur – 440 001

No. Vig/DE/07/2026

Dated at Nagpur the __.__.2026

The undersigned proposes to hold an inquiry against Shri R. ____, Postal Assistant, ____ Post Office (Employee No. ____), under Rule 14 of the Central Civil Services (Classification, Control and Appeal) Rules, 1965. The substance of the imputations of misconduct or misbehaviour in respect of which the inquiry is proposed to be held is set out in the enclosed **Statement of Articles of Charge (Annexure-I)**. A statement of the imputations of misconduct or misbehaviour in support of each Article of Charge is enclosed (**Annexure-II**). A list of documents by which, and a list of witnesses by whom, the Articles of Charge are proposed to be sustained are also enclosed (**Annexures-III and IV**).

2. Shri R. ____ is directed to submit, within **10 days** of the receipt of this Memorandum, a written statement of his defence and also to state whether he desires to be heard in person.

3. He is informed that an inquiry will be held only in respect of those Articles of Charge as are not admitted. He should, therefore, specifically admit or deny each Article of Charge.

4. He is further informed that if he does not submit his written statement of defence on or before the date specified in para 2 above, or does not appear in person before the Inquiring Authority, or otherwise fails or refuses to comply with the provisions of Rule 14 of the CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965, or the orders / directions issued in pursuance of the said Rule, the Inquiring Authority may hold the inquiry against him **ex parte**.

5. The attention of Shri R. ____ is invited to **Rule 20** of the CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964, under which no Government servant shall bring or attempt to bring any political or outside influence to bear upon any superior authority to further his interests. If any representation is received on his behalf from another person, it will be presumed that he is aware of it and that it has been made at his instance, and action will be taken accordingly.

6. The receipt of this Memorandum may be acknowledged.

Sd/- (Name)
Superintendent of Post Offices, Nagpur City Division
(Disciplinary Authority)

To

Shri R. ____, Postal Assistant, ____ Post Office.

ANNEXURE-I — STATEMENT OF ARTICLES OF CHARGE

Statement of Articles of Charge framed against Shri R. ____, Postal Assistant, ____ Post Office.

Article-I

That the said Shri R. ____, while functioning as Postal Assistant in charge of the Savings Bank counter at ____ Post Office during the period from __.__.2026 to __.__.2026, failed to maintain absolute integrity in that he fraudulently effected unauthorised withdrawals amounting to Rs. 40,000/- from SB Account No. ____ standing in the name of Smt. ____, by forging the depositor's signature on the withdrawal forms, and misappropriated the said amount for his personal use.

By his aforesaid act, the said Shri R. ____ failed to maintain absolute integrity and devotion to duty and acted in a manner unbecoming of a Government servant, and thereby contravened **Rule 3(1)(i), 3(1)(ii) and 3(1)(iii) of the CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964.**

Article-II

That during the aforesaid period and while functioning in the aforesaid office, the said Shri R. ____ made false entries in the SB journal and the SB ledger so as to conceal the said unauthorised withdrawals, thereby falsifying official records.

By his aforesaid act, the said Shri R. ____ again failed to maintain absolute integrity and acted in a manner unbecoming of a Government servant, and thereby contravened **Rule 3(1)(i) and 3(1)(iii) of the CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964.**

Sd/- (Name)

Superintendent of Post Offices, Nagpur City Division
(Disciplinary Authority)

ANNEXURE-II – STATEMENT OF IMPUTATIONS

Statement of imputations of misconduct or misbehaviour in support of the Articles of Charge framed against Shri R. ____, Postal Assistant.

In support of Article-I:

Shri R. ____ was in sole charge of the Savings Bank counter at ____ Post Office during the period __.__.2026 to __.__.2026. On verification of SB Account No. ____ by the Assistant Superintendent of Posts on __.__.2026, following a complaint by the depositor Smt. ____, it was found that three withdrawals totalling Rs. 40,000/- had been posted to the account on __, __ and __ though the depositor had made no such withdrawals and her pass-book carried no corresponding entries. The signatures on the withdrawal forms were found, on examination, not to be those of the depositor. The amount so withdrawn was not accounted for and was misappropriated by Shri R. ____.

In support of Article-II:

To conceal the said withdrawals, Shri R. ____ made false entries in the SB journal and the SB ledger which did not tally with the counterfoils and the depositor's pass-book, thereby falsifying the official records maintained in the ordinary course of duty. The discrepancy was established on comparison of the ledger, the journal and the withdrawal forms during the verification referred to above.

ANNEXURE-III – LIST OF DOCUMENTS

List of documents by which the Articles of Charge are proposed to be sustained:

1. The three SB withdrawal forms (SB-3) dated __, __ and __.
2. The SB ledger of Account No. ____.
3. The SB journals for the relevant dates.
4. The depositor's pass-book.
5. The complaint of the depositor dated __.__.2026.
6. The verification report of the Assistant Superintendent of Posts dated __.__.2026.
7. The opinion of the handwriting expert, if obtained.

ANNEXURE-IV — LIST OF WITNESSES

List of witnesses by whom the Articles of Charge are proposed to be sustained:

1. Shri ____, Assistant Superintendent of Posts, who conducted the verification.
2. Smt. ____, the depositor.
3. Shri ____, Sub-Postmaster / Postmaster of ____ Post Office.
4. The handwriting expert, if examined.

EXAM FOCUS**Exam focus — scoring the 20 marks**

- Reproduce the **six standard paragraphs** of the Memorandum — they carry the framework marks.
- Frame **at least two distinct Articles**, each ending with the **exact Conduct Rule** contravened.
- Make the **Imputations mirror the Articles** — do not leave a charge unsupported.
- List **documents (Annexure-III)** and **witnesses (Annexure-IV)** separately and numbered.
- Sign as the **Disciplinary Authority**, and name Rule 14 of the CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965 explicitly.

3.8 Minor-penalty proceedings — Rule 16

When the lapse deserves only a penalty in **Rule 11(i)–(iv)** — censure, withholding of promotion, recovery of a pecuniary loss, reduction by one stage under (iii-a), or withholding of increments — the procedure is the simpler one in **Rule 16**, and the examiner may ask for this memorandum instead. Its essentials:

1. The Government servant is **informed in writing** of the proposal to take action against him and of the **imputations of misconduct or misbehaviour** on which it is based (Rule 16(1)(a)).
2. He is given a **reasonable opportunity of making a representation** against the proposal.
3. An **inquiry** in the manner of Rule 14(3)–(23) is held **at the discretion** of the Disciplinary Authority where it considers one necessary (Rule 16(1)(b)).
4. The inquiry becomes **mandatory** where, after considering the representation, it is proposed to **withhold increments for more than three years, or with cumulative effect, or in a way likely to affect the pension adversely** (Rule 16(1-A)).

5. The DA then **records its findings** on each imputation and passes a **reasoned (speaking) order**, imposing a minor penalty or exonerating the official.

Point	Rule 14 (major)	Rule 16 (minor)
Penalties covered	Rule 11 (v)–(ix)	Rule 11 (i)–(iv), incl. (iii-a)
Core document	Memorandum + Annexures I–IV	Memorandum + statement of imputations
Inquiry	Mandatory (IO, PO, evidence)	DA's discretion; mandatory only in the Rule 16(1-A) situations
Reply sought	Written statement of defence	Representation against the proposal
Typical outcome	Dismissal / removal / compulsory retirement / reduction	Censure / recovery / withholding of increments or promotion



3.9 Model — Rule 16 memorandum (minor penalty)

Given topic: "Draft a memorandum for minor-penalty proceedings against a Postman who brought back accountable articles without remarks." Note the two-part shape — the proposal, and the imputation it rests on:

MODEL — RULE 16 MEMORANDUM

Department of Posts, India
Office of the Superintendent of Post Offices,
Nagpur City Division, Nagpur – 440 001

No. Vig/MP/03/2026

Dated at Nagpur the __.__.2026

MEMORANDUM

The undersigned proposes to take action against Shri R ____, Postman, ____ H.O., under **Rule 16 of the CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965**, for the imposition of one of the **minor penalties** specified in Rule 11 *ibid*. The imputations of misconduct on which the action is proposed are set out below.

Statement of Imputations. On __.__.2026, Shri R ____ was issued __ registered and __ Speed Post articles for delivery on Beat No. __. He returned __ **articles undelivered without any remarks** thereon and without recording the reasons in the prescribed records, in disregard of the standing instructions on delivery work. He thereby failed to maintain **devotion to duty** and acted in a manner unbecoming of a Government servant, contravening **Rule 3(1)(ii) and 3(1)(iii) of the CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964**.

2. Shri R ____ is given an opportunity to make, **within 10 days** of the receipt of this Memorandum, such **representation** as he may wish to make against the proposal.

3. If no representation is received within the said period, it will be presumed that he has none to make, and orders will be passed on the material available on record.

Sd/- (Name)

Superintendent of Post Offices, Nagpur City Division
(Disciplinary Authority)

To

Shri R ____, Postman, ____ H.O.

3.10 Charge-framing quick reference

Whatever the scenario, the Article must (i) fix the person, post, office and period, (ii) state the act or omission with its amount and effect, and (iii) end with the conduct standard contravened. Map the common lapses like this:

Lapse alleged	Frame the Article around	Conduct Rule cited
Misappropriation of SB / RD / TD deposits or of eMO amounts	Receipt of the money, non-accounting, retention for personal use — with period and amount	Rule 3(1)(i), (ii) & (iii)
Falsification of records to conceal a fraud	The specific false entries and the records affected	Rule 3(1)(i) & (iii)
Loss of an accountable bag / articles through negligence	The duty held, the failure of custody or dispatch, the loss caused	Rule 3(1)(ii) & (iii)
Unauthorised absence / desertion of duty	The dates of absence and the want of sanction or intimation	Rule 3(1)(ii) & (iii)
Disobedience of written orders	The order disobeyed (No. and date) and the act done or omitted	Rule 3(1)(ii)
Demanding or accepting illegal gratification	The demand or receipt, from whom, for what official act	Rule 3(1)(i) & (iii)

GOLDEN RULE

Two drafting commandments

- One Article = **one act of misconduct**. Split distinct acts into separate Articles.
- The charge sheet frames the charge; it **never proposes the penalty**. The penalty comes only with the final order — under Rule 15 in major cases, or with the Rule 16 order in minor cases.

4

SECTION

Rapid Revision

One-page recap of Paper-II

Topic	Remember this
Noting	Subject → facts → analysis (cite the rule) → recommendation → "Submitted for orders". ~200 words, numbered paras, sign with designation & date. (CSMOP, 2022, Ch. 7.)
Drafting	Pick the correct form first. Letter = "Sir / Yours faithfully"; O.M. = third person, no salutation; Office Order / Order = impersonal. Subject + reference + numbered body + signature block. (CSMOP, 2022, Chs. 8–9.)
Charge sheet	Major penalty (Rule 11 (v)–(ix)) → Rule 14. Memorandum (6 paras) + Annexure-I Articles + II Imputations + III Documents + IV Witnesses. Tie each Article to Rule 3 of CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964. Signed by the Disciplinary Authority.
Rule 16 (minor)	Inform in writing of the proposal + imputations; opportunity to represent; inquiry at the DA's discretion (mandatory in the Rule 16(1-A) situations); reasoned order. Penalties: Rule 11 (i)–(iv).

5

SECTION

Currency & Verification Record

Primary sources and the position confirmed

In keeping with Dak Guru's zero-error standard, the statutory content of this booklet has been checked against primary sources. Each source is recorded with its date so that currency can be judged independently.

Source (primary)	Used for / position confirmed
Central Secretariat Manual of Office Procedure (CSMOP), 2022 — 16th edition, Department of Administrative Reforms & Public Grievances (foreword dated 13.07.2022); confirmed current on the DARPG website.	Chapter 7 — guidelines on noting ; Chapter 8 — forms of communication ; Chapter 9 — guidelines on drafting . Current functionary terminology (Dealing Officer / CRU) and e-Office noting.
CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965 — Rule 11 , as available on the DoPT website.	List of minor and major penalties ; the (v)–(ix) test for applying Rule 14.
CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965 — Rule 14 , as available on the DoPT website (text reflecting the amendment introducing "ten working days", the Presenting Officer and retired-GS assistance).	The major-penalty procedure and the structure of the charge memorandum with Annexures I–IV.
CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965 — Rule 16 (including Rule 16(1-A)), text as in the DoPT compilation of the Rules (accessed September 2026).	The minor-penalty procedure — written proposal with imputations, representation, discretionary inquiry, and the 16(1-A) circumstances in which an inquiry is mandatory.
DoPT standard proforma of charge sheet for major penalties (Rule 14).	The six standard paragraphs of the Memorandum and the four-annexure layout of the specimen.
CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964 — Rule 3.	The standard of conduct (integrity / devotion to duty / conduct unbecoming) cited in the Articles of Charge.

DoPT Notification dated 12.01.2026 (latest CCS (CCA) amendment traced).	Confirmed that the latest amendment touches Rule 10(1) and Rule 12(4) only — not the Rule 14 charge-sheet mechanism.
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CURRENCY ALERT**Points flagged for the reader**

- The **time allowed for the written statement of defence** is fixed by the Disciplinary Authority in the memorandum ("within such time as may be specified", Rule 14(4)); **10 days** is the common administrative practice used in the specimen, not a figure fixed by the Rule itself.
- Likewise, the **10 days for the representation under Rule 16** in the specimen is administrative practice; Rule 16 itself requires only a reasonable opportunity.
- The **list of forms of communication** follows the CSMOP, 2022; the obsolete telegram/savingram of older editions is omitted in favour of e-mail/fax.
- All **names, amounts and dates in the specimens are illustrative** and must be replaced with the facts of the actual case.
- Verify the position afresh before an examination, as departmental orders and amendments may issue after **September 2026**.

